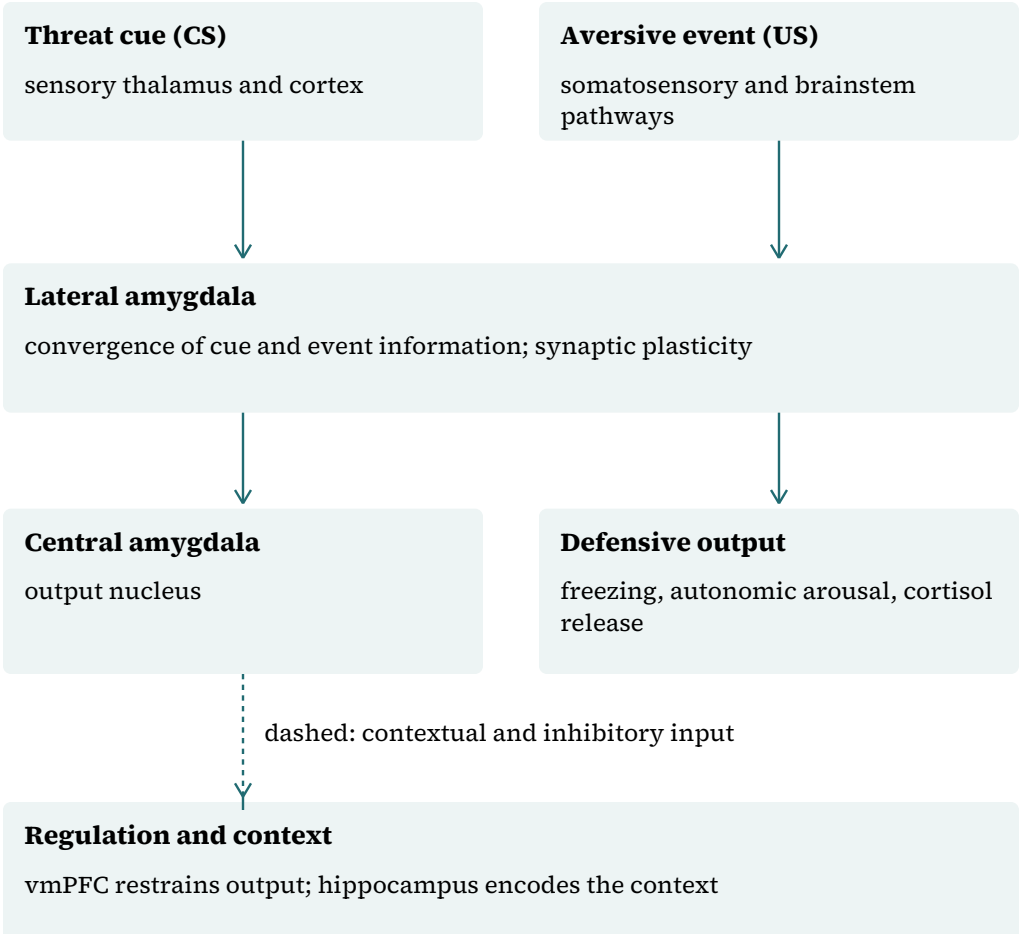
Threat cue (CS)
sensory thalamus and cortex
Aversive event (US)
somatosensory and brainstem pathways
Lateral amygdala
convergence of cue and event information; synaptic plasticity
Central amygdala
output nucleus
Defensive output
freezing, autonomic arousal, cortisol release
dashed: contextual and inhibitory input
Regulation and context
vmPFC restrains output; hippocampus encodes the context